



Sales Funnel & Sales Methodologies

A guide to being equipped with essential tools to be a better salesperson.



session objectives.

1

Understanding what is sales funnel & benefits of having it

2

Understanding every stage of the Sales Funnel

3

Understanding sales methodologies and Sandler Sales Methodology in greater detail.



What is Sales Funnel?

The sales funnel is an essential sales tool which provides a visual representation of the process of converting leads into a paying customer/client.

It is important to have a sales funnel in place in order to maximize conversions and revenue. The goal of any good sales funnel is to move customers/clients through each stage as efficiently as possible. By doing so, we can increase the likelihood of making a sale and generating revenue.

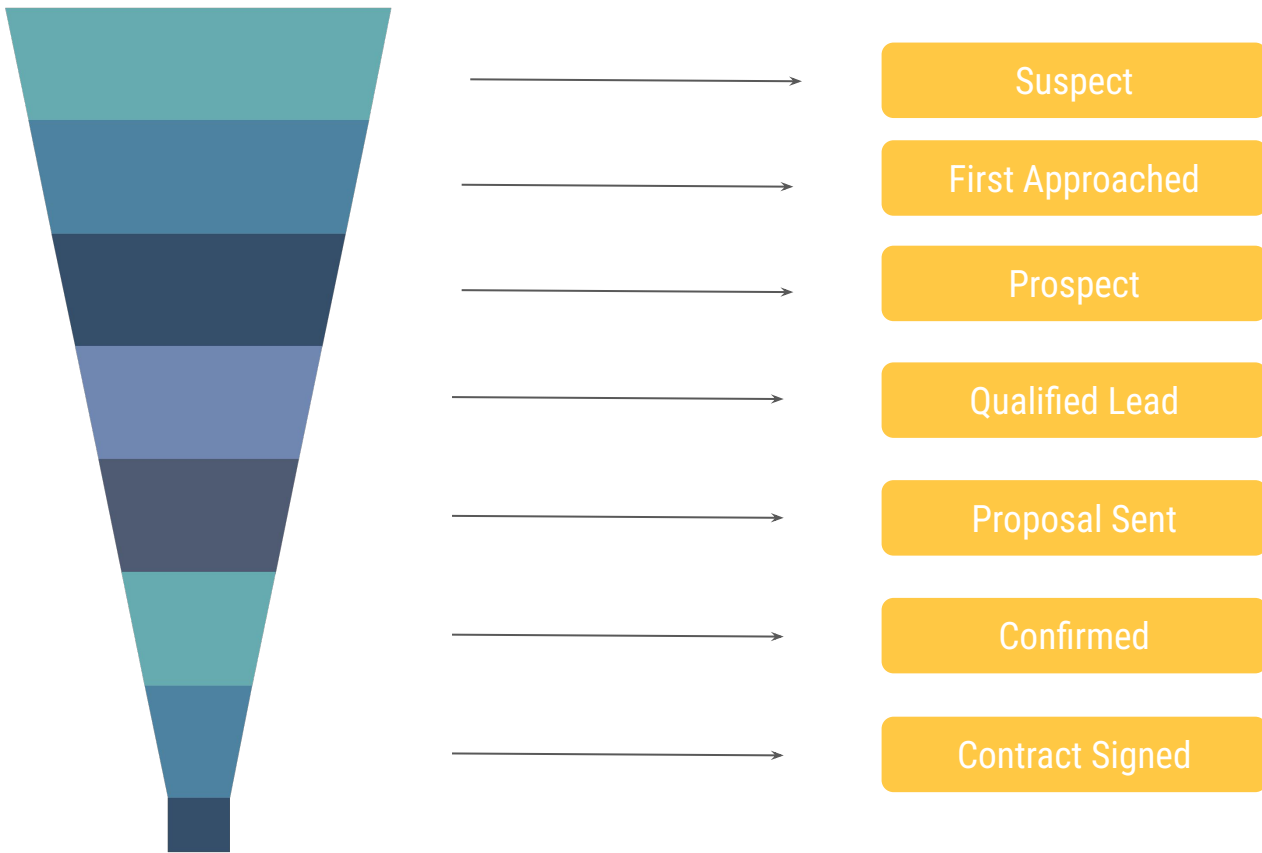


Benefits of having a sales funnel

1. **Allowing us to focus on our ideal customer/client:** By taking potential customers/clients through a series of steps, we can quickly determine who our ideal customer is. This saves time and resources that would otherwise be spent trying to sell to people who are not interested in the product or service.
2. **Building relationships with potential customers/clients:** Nurturing potential customers through the sales funnel helps us to build relationships with the customer/client. This can lead to repeat business and referrals down the road.
3. **Qualifying leads:** A sales funnel also allows us to qualify our leads, which means we can determine how likely someone is to buy our product or service. This information can be used to make decisions about where to allocate resources and how best to close the sale.



7 Stages of a Sales Funnel





Suspect Stage



1. **In this stage you suspect that the company/organization could be a possible partner for AIESEC.**
2. **However, you haven't had any connection or interaction with the suspect yet. You just think they might be interested in working with you.**



Approached Stage



- 1. To move from Suspect Stage to First Approached, make sure to have a short interaction with the suspect, i.e. a short call, conversation at a networking event, email exchanged, LinkedIn chat, etc.**
- 2. To first approach, AIESECers can find either find an Alumni or a Contact working at the Suspect Company. It is advisable to identify certain departments within the suspect company to reach out to: Eg. Talent Acquisition/HR, Marketing, Business Development, Employer Branding department, DEI etc**



Prospect Stage



1. **In Prospect Stage, the (potential customer) can be in this stage if you know that they have a need for which you can provide a solution.**
2. **You don't "suspect" anymore but you know they actually need you, however, you still don't have information about the budget, or their decision-making process, and you usually don't get that from the first meeting. Hence, you can't say it's a qualified lead yet. For you to qualify this opportunity, you can get the answers to the following questions during your touchpoint.**



Qualified Lead Stage

1. **In this stage, It refers to only organizations which you know the answer will be "yes"**
2. **Make sure that you have all the following information:**
 - **Timeline for the selection process**
 - **Each step of the selection process, e.g. if they will do more than 1 interview or a business case.**
 - **Number of trainees expected, if we are talking about GT.**
 - **Important dates: contract sign, delivery date, follow up meetings. Make sure to build this timeline together so the expectations are aligned from the beginning.**
3. **It's very important to use your time efficiently. As a sales representative, you can't send proposals in each stage of the sales pipeline, you should only send a proposal to leads that you know are qualified, so the negotiation is around the proposal and not between a "yes" or "no". That's how you ensure you're not wasting your time with people who will say no at the end.**
4. **In this stage, the customer is showing interest in our solution, why/how.**



Proposal Sent Stage

1. **In the Proposal Sent Stage: The Proposal should have been sent to the partner and in this stage Proper Follow-Up is essential after the proposal is sent.**
2. **Insights evaluation after you get their answer.**
3. **Define the next meeting and the objective, for example, for negotiating the pricing, if needed or defining the final timeline and details.**
4. **In this stage, it's recommended to have a written acceptance, i.e. "I agree on what you've sent us" so you can have a clearer update.**



Confirmed Stage



1. **In the Confirmed Stage: The Proposal that you sent to the partner should have been confirmed by the partner.**
2. **In this stage, you send the contract package including all the annexes, after following your internal procedures, i.e. your legal team reviews the contract and the conditions defined.**
3. **Follow up on the signature process**



Contract Signed Stage



1. **In this stage: Celebrate, please do!**
2. **Make sure to keep the tracking in your CRM, by doing it you ensure that the delivery will be successful**
3. **Remember to involve the team in charge of delivering the partnership signed and appreciate them for closing the deal and the sale.**
4. **After this, the sales becomes an account. You hand the company over to an assigned account manager to deliver the contractual obligations and ensure to follow up on the invoice for the payment process from the sale.**



What are Sales Methodologies?

A Methodology is any framework that outlines how you approach each phase of a process. In Sales it refers to discipline, through a system of principles and best practices that translate into seller actions.

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Example of a Sales Methodology



The Sandler Selling Life Cycle

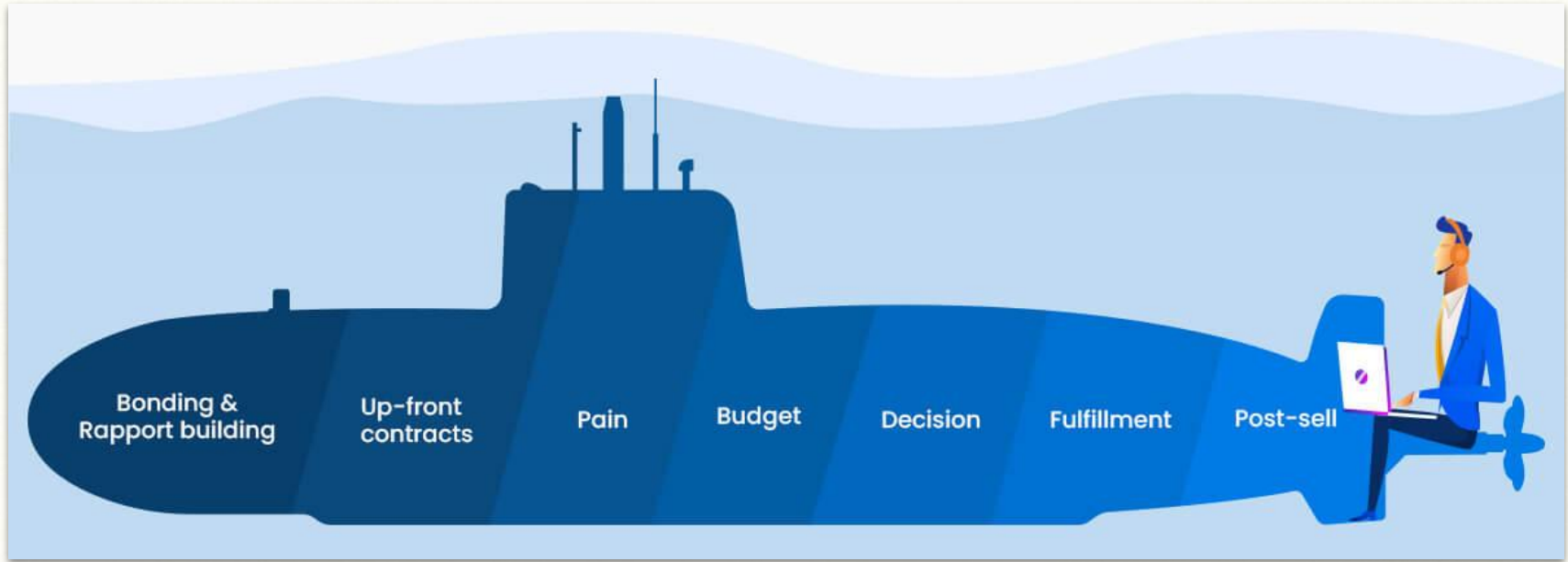


The Sandler Method by David Sandler: Created in 1967 by psychologist of human behaviour, David Sandler. It is a method that focuses on "Asking the right questions" rather than simply providing answers, it divided into **3 parts: Establishing a Relationship, Qualifying a Prospect and Closing the Sale.**



The Sandler Sales Methodology

A 3 part methodology that involves Establishing a Relationship, Qualifying a Prospect and Closing the Sale.





#1 Establishing the relationship



1. Bonding & Rapport

“Developing a positive relationship with the prospect based on mutual trust”

Examples:

www.toptier.sandler.com/blog_article/show/24519

2. Upfront Contacts

Outlining and setting the expectations of the meeting

Elements of an Up-Front Contract:

1. Purpose of the meeting
2. Time Consideration
3. Prospect's agenda and expectations
4. Sales Person agenda and expectations
5. Outcome/Next Steps



#2 Qualifying the Prospect



This Phase allows people to build up mutual trust by:
Asking questions to determine whether the solution being offered is actually the right fit for the client.

3. Pain

We uncover the surface problems the prospect faces, the underlying reasons for those surface problems, and the personal impact of those problems.

We should ask plenty of questions, as the real problems they need to solve might not be the obvious ones.

4. Budget

Rather than naming a price, we ask for some realistic financial guidelines from the prospect in order to craft a solution.

You should also cover other potential budget concerns like time and personnel when applicable

5. Decision

We determine whether the prospect is qualified to make the decision about moving forward. If the prospect has decision-making power, the asks the right questions to understand the criteria they need to meet in order to make a final decision. Then, understanding all of those conditions, the salesperson asks if anything else could prevent the prospect from going forward.



#3 Closing the sale



We leave it up to the prospect to close the deal. Instead of pushing for the close, if we have asked the right questions, will have the prospect closing the sale themselves by asking to move forward.

6. Fulfillment

Asking the last questions to settle details and Time to sign the contract

and get starting on delivering as promised.

7. Post-Sell

We determine whether the prospect is qualified to make the decision about moving forward. If the prospect has decision-making power, the asks the right questions to understand the criteria they need to meet in order to make a final decision. Then, understanding all of those conditions, the salesperson asks if anything else could prevent the prospect from going forward.

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